MGMT627
Project Management
Mid Term Subjectives

Characteristic of project manager. (Marks: 3)
Characteristic of project manager include:

- Time Management
- Communication Skills
- Conflict Resolution
- Personal Traits
- Experience
- Goal Setting
- Responsibility
- Organization
- Leadership Skills
- Objective Views

Preparation for Future Proposal: (Marks: 3)
You collect various data that could be used to prepare project proposals. As this process is costly, so you store these data and use it in future to make proposals. *Lesson 13.* ***Page No.107***

What is project planning? (Marks: 5)
Planning is the process of formulating goals and objectives, and developing ways and plans to achieve these goals is called planning. When this process is done for a project, it is called project planning.

Functional Manager versus Project Manager: (Marks: 5)
Functional manager is a manager who manages the activities of one organizational function or department. E.g. marketing manager, HR manager etc.

A manager who is responsible for a specific project that involves coordinating people and activities in several departments is project manager.

Lesson 6. ***Page No.53***

Numbering of WBS. Give example. (Marks: 5)
Different activities or work packages in work breakdown structure are numbered for their identification.
In WBS, the whole project is subdivided into individual work activities through different levels. You can understand its numbering with this example:

Plant Construction 1

- Analytical Study 1.1
- Marketing Study 1.1.1
- Production Study 1.1.2
- Cost Analysis 1.1.3
- Design & Layout 1.2
- Process Sketches 1.2.1
- Process Blueprints 1.2.2
- Installation 1.3
- Fabrication 1.3.1
- Setup 1.3.2
- Testing 1.3.3
- Support 1.4
- Management 1.4.1
- Raw Material 1.4.2

Lesson 22 & 23.

What are the three questions after the project objectives declared?

1. Are the project objectives the same?
2. Is there a distinction between large and small projects?
3. How do we handle conflicting priorities?

System integration and its objectives (Marks: 5)

System integration is the process in which different systems or functions are integrated to achieve the goals. In projects, its objectives include:

- To achieve performance of project
- To increase effectiveness of project
- To minimize cost of project

Power and authority problems in the project environment. (Marks: 5)

Power and authority problems in the project environment result in conflicts, project delays and ultimately project failure. Some of sources are:

- Poorly documented or no formal authority
- Power and authority perceived incorrectly
- Dual accountability of personnel
- Two bosses (who often disagree)
- The project organization encouraging individualism
- Subordinate relations stronger than peer or superior relationships

- Shifting of personnel loyalties from vertical to horizontal lines
- Group decision making based on the strongest group
- Ability to influence or administer rewards and punishment
- Sharing resources among several projects

Work break down structure for construction a plant and its guidelines? (Marks: 5)

When scope and deliverables of a project are defined, the work of project can be successively sub divided into smaller and smaller activities. The outcome of this hierarchical process is called Work breakdown structure (WBS).

Lecture 22 & 23. ***Page No.156***

What are senior management activities at planning phase?

You will learn this topic in lesson 19. ***Page No.146***

Some of senior management responsibilities at planning phase are:

- Maintain a close involvement with project teams
- Strategic planning must define the authority, responsibility, and roles of the strategic planning personnel
- Strategic project planning is a job that should be performed by managers, not for them.

Contents of procurement planning at project planning checklist

Lesson 16. ***Page No.127***

Contents of procurement planning in this checklist are:

1. Procurement sources (equipment, materials)
2. Home office versus field procurement
3. Long lead time items
4. Logistical planning

Attributes of selecting a project manager?

These are skills or qualities that a project manager must possess. Some of these are:

- Team building
- Leadership
- Conflict resolution
- Technical expertise
- Planning
- Organization
- Entrepreneurship
- Administration
- Management support
- Resource allocation

What are objectives of internal project planning? (Marks: 5)

The internal projects require the same level of attention and dedication as external projects. They use cash to strive for business results:

- Competitive advantage
- Cost savings
- Increased revenues

What mistakes made by project manager at the time of objective setting? (Marks: 5)

Lesson 20. ***Page No.146***

Describe the elements of the Atkinson model of Project? (Marks: 3)

Atkinson describes the project success in three stages:

1. The delivery stage: the process – doing it right
2. The post-delivery stage: the system – getting it right.
3. The post-delivery stage: the benefits – getting them right

Advantages of Functional structure organization? (Marks: 3)

- Simple and clear; coordination left to top management
- Reduces overhead
- Provides clearly marked career paths for hiring and promotion
- Employees work alongside colleagues who share similar interests

How many why & types of Proposal? (Marks: 3)

1. Internal Proposal
2. External Proposal
3. Solicited Proposal
4. Unsolicited Proposal

Barrier in planning phase.

- Most time-consuming project management activity.
- Continuous activity from initial concept through sys delivery.
- Plans must be regularly revised as new info becomes avail.

Write five procedures that can assist project manager during planning activities.(Marks: 5)

• Identification of company strengths and weaknesses
• Understanding personal values of top management
• Identification of opportunities
• Definition of product market
• Identification of competitive edge

• Establishment of goals, objectives, and standards
• Identification of resource deployment

Lesson 19.

Three benefits of average rate of return method. (Marks: 3)

- It is simple
- Effective when interest rate is extremely low and
- Rate of inflation is nil

Write down the causes of SOW (Marks: 5)

Statement of Work (SOW) is a narrative description of work required for the project. Often it is misinterpreted by the people involved in project. Some causes of misinterpretation of SOW are:

1. Mixing Tasks, Specs, Approvals, Special instructions
2. Using imprecise Language ("nearly“, "optimum“, "approximately" etc.)
3. No pattern, structure, or chronological order
4. Wide variation in Size of Tasks
5. Wide variation in how to describe Details of the work
6. Failing to get 3rd Party Review ISO 9000

Lesson 20.

5 points of what difficulties management faces while objective setting (Marks: 5)

Lesson 20. ***Page No.146***

Leadership skill (Marks: 3)

These are the skills that enable a person to lead effectively. For a project manager, leadership skills can be:

- Clear project leadership and direction
- Assistance in problem solving
- Facilitating the integration of new members into the team
- Ability to handle interpersonal conflict
- Facilitating group decisions
- Capability to plan and elicit commitments
- Ability to communicate clearly
- Presentation of the team to higher management
- Ability to balance technical solutions against economic and human factors

Write some barriers against effective proposal (Marks: 5)

. Required elements missing

o Budget justification

o Vital support letters

· Unrealistic goals & objectives for project

· Needs assessment not supported by reliable data

- Information – based on emotion
- Weak methodology – not a convincing case for project
- Typos or excessive jargon
- Scope is too narrow

How policies are predetermined general course or guides? (Marks: 5)

Policies are predetermined general courses or guides based on the following:

- Subordinate policies are supplementary to superior policies.
- Policies are based upon known principles in the operative areas.
- Policies should be definable, understandable, and preferably in writing.
- Policies should be both flexible and stable.
- Policies should be reasonably comprehensive in scope.

Write 3 contents of construction project which are mentioned in its checklist (Marks: 3)

Contents of construction project checklist:

1. Facility turnover sequence
2. Temporary facilities, offices, warehousing, etc
3. Tool and equipment requirements
4. Labor availability and productivity
5. Work week and productivity impact
6. Climatic effects on field work
7. Field engineering assistance required
8. Extent of subcontracting
9. Field organization and staffing

Responsibilities of project manager at planning stage (Marks: 5)

Lesson 18. ***Page No.***

Responsibilities of project manager at planning stage include identification of:

- Goals and objectives
- Major milestones
- Requirements
- Ground rules and assumptions
- Time, cost, and performance constraints
- Operating procedures
- Administrative policy

· Reporting requirements

What are the drawbacks of writing the typical specification? (Marks: 5)
Drawbacks of writing the typical specification are:

· They use twice pages as necessary.
· Do not stress on quality enough.
· Loaded with unnecessary designs and schematics.
· Difficult to read & update.
· Obsolete before publication.
· Streamlining with existing specifications is costly and time consuming effort

Lesson 21.
Three financial factors used in project evaluation? (Marks: 3)
Financial factors used in project evaluation: Most of the numeric models of project evaluation are based on financial factors. These include:

· Payback Period
· Average Rate of Return
· Discounted Cash Flow
· Internal Rate of Return
· Profitability Index

Characteristics of Breakdown structure and problems of its decomposition?
Characteristics of WBS: In project planning, after identifying the scope and deliverables of project, the work of project can be subdivided into smaller and smaller work elements. The outcome of this hierarchical process is called work breakdown structure (WBS). WBS is a map of project which assures project managers that all products and work elements are identified. It helps to integrate the project with the current organization and to establish a basis for control. Basically, WBS is an outline of project with different levels of detail.

Decomposition problem: Formulating a WBS is actually decomposition of whole project into work activities through a hierarchy. Usually it is considered that this decomposition of project is a simple and easy task but actually it is not. So considering that WBS decomposition is an easy job is a problem.

Three points of strategic planning of competitive environment (Marks: 3)
Lesson 19. ***Page No.141***
Five points of strategic planning of competitive environment (Marks: 5)
Lesson 19. ***Page No.141***
Industry characteristics
Competitive planning

Competitive history
Return on investments
Company requirements and goals
Market share.

The three basic strategies project variables of internal environment? (Marks: 3)
These would be discussed in lesson 19. ***Page No.141***
Strategic variables of internal environment are:

- Management skills
- Resources
- Wage and salary levels
- Government freeze on jobs
- Minority groups
- Layoffs
- Sales forecasts

Three points of *strategic planning* of external environment (Marks: 3)
Lesson 19. ***Page No.141***
Role of line manager in planning
Lesson 20. ***Page No.146***
Write three *strategic Project variables* of external environment. (Marks: 3)
Lesson 19.
You as a contractor are required to prepare the work Breakdown structure for the plant construction, what guiding would u follow to accomplish this task. (Marks: 5)
Lesson 23.
Describe following cost estimation techniques
*** bottom up approach**
*** parametric approach**
*** computerize approach**